

명사 꾸미기: -는 / -(으)ㄴ / -(으)ㄹ

Describing words go before the noun in Korean: verbs take -는 (now), -(으)ㄴ (past), or -(으)ㄹ (future), and adjectives take -(으)ㄴ. 있다/없다 words take -는, ㄹ-stems drop ㄹ, and most ㅁ-adjectives change ㅁ to 우.

WHAT THIS IS FOR



Learners will be able to form the correct noun-modifying ending (-는, -(으)ㄴ, -(으)ㄹ) for verbs, adjectives, and irregular stems.

1 THE PATTERN

Verb + -는 (present) The action is happening now or happens regularly. Add -는 to the verb stem, whether it ends in a vowel or a consonant: 먹다 → 먹는, 마시다 → 마시는.	the (noun) that someone does / is doing	지금 커피를 마시는 사람이 제 친구예요. The person who is drinking coffee right now is my friend.
Verb + -(으)ㄴ (past) The action is already finished. If the stem ends in a consonant, add -은 (먹다 → 먹은). If it ends in a vowel, add -ㄴ (보다 → 본).	the (noun) that someone did	어제 먹은 음식이 좀 짭어요. The food I ate yesterday was a bit salty.
Verb + -(으)ㄹ (future / planned) The action has not happened yet, or it is something you plan or need to do. If the stem ends in a consonant, add -을 (먹다 → 먹을). If it ends in a vowel, add -ㄹ (보다 → 볼).	the (noun) that someone will do / is going to do	이번 주말에 볼 영화를 아직 못 정했어요. I still haven't decided on a movie to watch this weekend.
Adjective + -(으)ㄴ Use this for any adjective describing a noun. If the stem ends in a consonant, add -은 (작다 → 작은). If it ends in a vowel, add -ㄴ (크다 → 큰).	a (noun) that is ~	작은 가방 말고 큰 가방 있어요? Do you have a big bag instead of a small one?
있다 / 없다 words + -는 Words ending in 있다 or 없다 (맛있다, 재미없다, 있다, 없다) take -는 (not -은) to describe a noun in the present, even when they work like adjectives in English.	a (noun) that is ~ / that has ~	재미없는 영화는 끝까지 못 봐요. I can't sit through a boring movie.
ㄹ-stem + -는 / -ㄴ / -ㄹ When the stem ends in ㄹ, the ㄹ drops before -는 and -ㄴ. With -ㄹ, the two ㄹ merge into one. Do not add 으. Verbs: 살다 → 사는 / 산 / 살, 만들다 → 만드는 / 만든 / 만들. Adjectives: 길다 → 긴, 멀다 → 먼.	same meanings as above (present / past / future, or adjective state)	이건 제가 직접 만든 케이크예요. This is a cake I made myself.
ㅁ-irregular adjective + -ㄴ Most adjectives ending in ㅁ change ㅁ to 우 and then add -ㄴ: 춥다 → 추운, 어렵다 → 어려운. A few are regular and keep ㅁ, for example 좁다 → 좁은.	a (noun) that is ~	어려운 단어는 선생님께 물어보세요. Ask your teacher about difficult words.





2 WATCH OUT

맛있은 음식 (X) → 맛있는 음식 (O): Words ending in 있다/없다 take -는 (not -은), even when you are describing a quality.

서울에 오래 살은 사람 / 사은 사람 (X) → 서울에 오래 산 사람 (O): With ㄹ-stems, drop the ㄹ and add -ㄴ. Do not add 은. The same goes for 만들은 (X) → 만들는 (O).

요즘 매일 먹은 빵 (X) → 요즘 매일 먹는 빵 (O): For a habit that is happening now, use -는. -(으)ㄴ on a verb means the action is finished and in the past.

3 YOUR TURN

- 1 Change the verb in brackets to fit the sentence: 어제 도서관에서 (읽다 → ____) 책은 정말 재미있었어요.
- 2 Change the verb in brackets to fit the sentence: 내일 면접 때 (입다 → ____) 옷을 미리 골라 뒀어요.
- 3 Change the adjective in brackets to fit the sentence: 집에서 (가깝다 → ____) 병원이 어디예요?
- 4 Change the word in brackets to fit the sentence: 저기 (멋있다 → ____) 모자를 쓴 사람이 우리 선생님이예요.
- 5 There are two mistakes in these sentences. Find them and fix them: 오늘은 정말 덥은 날이예요. 그래서 머리가 길은 사람들은 머리를 묶었어요.

ANSWERS

- | | |
|--------|--------------------|
| 1) 읽은 | 4) 멋있는 |
| 2) 입을 | 5) 덥은 → 더운, 길은 → 긴 |
| 3) 가까운 | |

